

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
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Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA